

The costs of Mark's choices are tremendous. But there's only one person responsible, and that's Mark! He keeps chasing the dream of happiness and fulfillment in the shape of a short skirt. It's hell on his bank account and confusing for his kids. Linda and I are pretty good friends with his third ex-wife, and she says it's been heartbreaking for their young son, too. Mark Jr. can't keep up with who's who. He gets ferried from his mom's house and then to his dad's, and at his dad's he can't keep track of the changing women. You know who's going to be paying that kid's therapy bills in a few years? Mark, that's who.

Mark's oldest kids are in their 20s. They're resentful, and they're quickly racking up more expenses for Daddy. To complicate matters, Mark's latest girlfriend had a baby a few weeks ago. Any hopes Mark had of putting some pieces of his first family back together just flew out the window. His midlife crisis cost him his dynasty.

I'm not claiming any moral superiority over anyone, and I'll be the first to say that if you think marriage is a walk in the park all the time, you're kidding yourself. All relationships have their ups and downs, their own trials and tribulations. Linda and I have had our share of struggles. But I'm happy to say our marriage has survived through it all, and today it's stronger than ever before. Hold firm, remember your values—and your net worth as a couple—and all will be well.

Money Mistake: *Your Partner's Bad Habits Are Becoming a Financial Burden*

The Fix: *Issue an Ultimatum Before All Your Investments Are Drained*

Most men (and women) get over their midlife crises. The smart ones realize that what they have in a marriage—or in any long-term relationship—is valuable. They're never going to have that depth of history with a new partner, no matter how perfect, sexy or desirable that partner may seem. A wise man will choose the dynasty over the arm candy, the true wealth over the short-term bling.